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MYSTERY**Helicopters**

by Erich A. Aggen, Jr.



Mysterious unmarked and/or unidentified helicopters have been linked with large numbers of cattle mutilations, UFO sightings and other unusual phenomena over the past twenty-five or thirty years. In addition, many UFO witnesses and purported UFO abductees have reported that mysterious helicopters have frequently flown and/or hovered over their homes at very low altitudes. The same witnesses have also reported that mysterious helicopters have followed them on numerous occasions. Mystery helicopters have also been observed apparently "investigating" enigmatic UFO-related incidents such as the Rock Creek Canyon "explosions" and the "blue flare" noted later in this article.

Obviously, these mysterious helicopters are REAL and they are being flown by REAL PILOTS and they come from REAL BASES somewhere! The question is WHO and WHERE? The vast majority of mystery helicopter reports involve relatively short-range helicopters such as McDonnell Douglas 500/503 Defenders (aka OH-6 Cayuses), Bell Iroquois, Bell Jet Rangers (aka Kiowas), McDonnell Douglas Apaches, Bell Huey Cobras, and in lesser numbers, Sikorsky Blackhawks and Boeing CH-47 Chinooks. All of these helicopters, with the exception of the Chinook, have ranges of only 373 to 428 miles. The Chinook, if not burdened with a large payload, has a one-way "ferry range" of 633 to 1275 miles. But the typical mission range for the Chinook is only 115 miles. Thus, the vast majority of mystery helicopters must operate from bases within a 200 to 250 mile RADIUS from where they are sighted unless they are fitted with oversized fuel tanks or special drop tanks which would considerably extend their normal operational range (radius) but severely limit their payload capability.

Today one in three military aircraft are helicopters and the U.S. Army is the world's largest user of helicopters. Over 4000 Bell UH-1H Iroquois Utility Transport helicopters, for example, have been produced and delivered to the U.S. Army and another 1400 have been delivered to foreign customers.

If the majority of unknown helicopter reports involve actual human-manufactured aircraft we can assume that most of these aircraft are probably military in origin and operate from either secret or publically-known military bases within the operational range of the particular helicopter types.

Since the end of World War II the U.S. Military has been engaged in a vast amount of underground construction. Undoubtedly, much of this construction consists of nuclear-hardened military bases which were designed to keep operating even after an all-out nuclear war. Thus, we can deduce that there are probably dozens, if not hundreds, of secret military bases hidden all over the United States which would not be recognized as such since very little evidence would be visible or obvious on the surface near such bases. Mystery helicopters could operate from such bases virtually undetected.

The following cases from the 1970's to the present involve mystery helicopters sighted in conjunction with UFOs, cattle mutilations or related phenomena. In each case possible known military bases are listed which may have been the base(s) of operation for the particular helicopter types involved.

CASE #1: Mid-70's, San Luis Valley, Colorado/ A young couple coming into San Luis passed a property where 17 cattle mutilations

had been reported and observed a helicopter that had a LIVE COW IN A HARNESS HANGING FROM IT directly over the highway. They reported their sighting to the sheriff but when they returned to the area about 6 miles east of San Luis, the only evidence they were able to find was a spot in the center of the highway where the cow had apparently urinated. They later found a mutilated animal (unknown type) about a mile away. NEWS SOURCE: Rocky Mountain News, 4/14/93.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Fort Carson (4 miles south of Colorado Springs); Kirtland AFB, Albuquerque, NM; Peterson AFB (3 miles east of Colorado Springs).

CASE #2: December 29, 1980, near Huffman Texas/ Betty Cash and Vickie and Colby Landrum encountered a diamond-shaped UFO at treetop height hovering above the road in front of them. The UFO was bright and making considerable noise. All three witnesses later suffered from symptoms identical to radiation sickness. The witnesses observed a large number (over 20) of double-rotor Chinook helicopters and other single-rotor helicopters (possibly huey cobras or Iroquois) apparently "escorting" the UFO. The Air Force denied the helicopters belonged to them. NEWS SOURCE: Various publications.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Huffman AFB, TX; Chase Field Naval Air Station (5 miles southeast of Beeville, TX); Fort Hood (28 miles west of Temple, TX).

MESSENGER, Cairo, GA

July 29, 1992 CR: M. Meadows

Watching UFO Watchers?



Ed Komarek Jr., local MUFON field representative, says UFO witnesses in Grady County and vicinity are wondering who's flying those unmarked helicopters around their homes and adjoining surroundings. He provided this photo and reported that Mary Ann Meadows, a UFO witness, took the picture as a man inside the chopper photographed her when she stepped out into the yard at her residence of Cairo.

Komarek added that a neighbor reported seeing a chopper over his property while he was lecturing on UFOs recently, in Gulf Breeze, Florida, an area he described as "a national hotspot."

"UFO literature is full of cases of witnesses under surveillance around the country and the world. Now, unless information surfaces to the contrary, perhaps Grady County can be added to that large number of cases attesting to high level military and government involvement in UFOs," Komarek said.

CASE #3: 1993, rural Sand Mountain community of northeast Alabama/ In five months over 20 cases of dead, mutilated animals were reported in Dekalb and Marshall counties. Most of the animals were cows but there were some goats and one dog. In several of the cases helicopters were seen flying at treetop level in areas where the animals were mutilated. NEWS SOURCE: UFO Newsclipping Service.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Fort McClellan (northeast of Anniston, AL); Redstone Arsenal, Huntsville, AL.

CASE #4: January 1993, Moffat, Colorado/ A rancher returning from Salida, Colorado on Highway 17 saw a "dark green two-man helicopter" menacing his herd of horses in a corral next to the highway. The helicopter was hovering less than 100 feet from his herd. The helicopter had an FAA Identification number but it appeared to be incomplete. NEWS SOURCE: Mysterious Valley Report.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Same as Case #1.

CASE #5: February 25, 1993, Rainsville, Alabama/ A bright sphere-shaped UFO with "peculiar projections of light being emitted" was sighted and photographed above south Dekalb county. The

photographer said the UFO looked like "a big star" but was about four times brighter and three or four times larger than any star in the sky. The UFO appeared to get brighter, rotate, and change colors. Witnesses also said that several helicopters seemed to be flying "in close proximity" to the UFO. On the same night a witness in Sylvania reported what appeared to be "planes" flying under a similar UFO. NEWS SOURCE: Weekly Post, Rainsville, AL, 2/25/93. POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Redstone Arsenal, Huntsville, AL; Fort McClellan (SE of Anniston, AL).

CASE #6: April 21, 1993, Pensacola, Florida/ Several witnesses observed a UFO as it appeared in the middle of a broad expanse of clear sky. The UFO was fairly stable as it dimmed and brightened with no particular rhythm, pulsating from a bright to a brighter red. Through a pair of binoculars one witness was able to see that the one red light was actually three very close lights in a triangular formation. During the sighting witnesses heard a helicopter approaching from behind them. AS THE HELICOPTER CAME CLOSE THE UFO CHANGED TO A VERY BRIGHT WHITE LIGHT AND EMITTED A SERIES OF RAPID FLASHES AS IF IT WAS SENDING A CODED MESSAGE AT A HIGH RATE OF SPEED. As the helicopter passed overhead the UFO slowly faded from sight. NEWS SOURCE: UFO Newsclipping Service & the Pensacola, FL Islander.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Eglin AFB (40 miles east of Pensacola); Navy Air Station (5 miles southwest of Pensacola); Whiting Field Naval Air Station (35 miles northeast of Pensacola).

CASE #7: September 22, 1993, Pensacola Beach, Florida/ Around 7:48 PM, six witnesses observed a large, amber, egg-shaped UFO in the sky to the NNW of Greenbriar Circle in Tiger Point. One witness estimated the UFO was about ten feet in diameter. The UFO was moving silently to the ENE at about 10 miles per hour. After observing the UFO for a short time a large helicopter was sighted toward the west coming from behind the roofline of a house. It approached the UFO and the UFO suddenly disappeared. After several seconds the witness was able to make out a dim ring of eight independent lights. The ring of lights then accelerated to 30 to 50 miles per hour and the helicopter veered due north. NEWS SOURCE: UFO Newsclipping Service.

POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Same as Case #6.

CASE #8: January 19 & 22, 1994, Rock Creek, Colorado/ During January NORAD reported a "significant explosion" in the Rock Creek Canyon/Fuchs Reservoir area (January 12th), and five days later three different Rock Creek area residents reported sighting a "blue flare" in the night sky. Police investigated the explosion and the blue flare but were unable to find anything to account for the strange reports. Several other unexplained explosions were reported in the Rock Creek area in January but could not be verified. A short time after the unusual reports a deputy sheriff reported sighting three unidentified and unmarked helicopters flying in a SEARCH PATTERN back and forth over the foothills in the Rock Creek Canyon area. Two of the helicopters had large blue strobe lights and the third was illuminated with red, blue, and white lights. They were flying from the 2S (a road) to the 9S and from the top of Greenie to the county line. The U.S. Army, Air Force, and Colorado and New Mexico National Guard units all denied the helicopters belonged to them. However, when an investigator called NORAD to ask about the helicopters he was told "THAT'S CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION."

Intriguingly, a month before the Rock Creek Canyon sightings, on December 1st, between 8:30 to 9:30 PM, TWO FORMATIONS OF UNIDENTIFIED HELICOPTERS were

videotaped as they searched the valley in a region where WITNESSES SAW AN "OBJECT" COME DOWN on the previous night. A TOTAL OF TEN CRAFT WERE OBSERVED SEARCHING THE AREA between Hooper and La Garita. THEY SEEMED TO BE SILENT.
NEWS SOURCE: Crestone Eagle, February 1994 & UFO Newsclipping Service.
POSSIBLE HELICOPTER BASES: Same as Case #1.

According to cattle mutilation investigator Ted Oliphant, a former spokesman for the U.S. Air Force Strategic Air Command at Sawyer Air Force Base in Marquette, Michigan, mystery helicopters have been sighted in the vicinity of more than 90% of cattle mutilations. He also claims that the majority of helicopters involved in cattle mutilations are Bell Jet Rangers (aka OH-58 Kiowas). The mystery helicopters are usually black, dark gray, light blue or light green in color and unmarked.

Curiously, author Ed Conroy described some ATYPICAL mystery helicopters in his book, Report on Communion. While most mystery helicopters are black or dark in color and totally unmarked, the helicopter sighting reports in Report on Communion involved Chinook-type two-rotor helicopters, Bell "47-model" helicopters, and only a few of the more common Huey-types: in one case a Chinook was painted red, blue, and white; in another a Chinook was painted brown with a horizontal red stripe running through the cabin and down the tail; in a third case a Bell 47-model helicopter had a blue fuselage and the metal enclosing the cockpit bubble was painted white. The helicopter was unmarked and had a searchlight in the nose. In the latter case the Bell 47-model helicopter made several close passes near the author's office in a seven-story building located in the middle of downtown San Antonio, Texas while shining a spotlight directly in his window! Conroy stated that he could "hardly go anywhere" in San Antonio during the spring and summer of 1988 without seeing a mysterious helicopter beside or above his car, or even above his bicycle when he was out riding.

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CREDIT: Credit for the newsclipping on page two, "Watching UFO Watchers?" goes to the August 1992 issue (#277) of Lucius Farish's outstanding UFO Newsclipping Service. We highly recommend this excellent source of current ufological news to all of our readers. Subscription information and sample pages from the UFO Newsclipping Service are available upon request from: Route 1, Box 220, Plumerville, Arkansas 72127.

CLOSING NOTES: The mystery helicopter photographed in the above newsclipping is a Bell UH-1 Iroquois with a range of about 400 miles (511 kilometers). Possible bases this type of helicopter could operate from include: Fort Benning, Columbus, GA; Moody AFB, Valdosta, GA; Albany Naval Air Station, GA; Robins AFB, Warner Robins, GA; Cecil Field Naval Air Station, Jacksonville, FL; Jacksonville Naval Air Station, FL; Eglin AFB, FL; Pensacola Naval Air Station, FL; Mayport Naval Air Station, FL (near Jacksonville); and Whiting Field Naval Air Station, FL (NE of Pensacola).

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